

PROJECT PLAN: ASSESSING LOCAL TRENDS IN CONTRIBUTORS TO YOUTH TRAUMA

Emily Fetsch

emily@justicemattersinkansas.org

ABSTRACT

Justice Matters is an Interfaith non-profit organization consisting of religious congregations joined together with the shared mission of creating a more just community. Each year, the organization selects a current issue to better understand and address. The focus of this project is to develop an understanding of factors that contribute to trauma suffered by youth in Douglas County by analyzing local-level data and understanding the impact of the most effective preventative policies.

1 INTRODUCTION

Justice Matters developed a research process to assess major community issues and find effective ways to address them. This year, the organization found that youth trauma was predominant issue in the Douglas County community and thus became a priority for the organization.

This project will better inform Justice Matters's research process and sustain their advocacy efforts for years to come. There are two primary goals for this project: (1) understand factors that contribute to youth trauma by analyzing local-level data; (2) assess data from research on effective policies to better inform which method is the best to adapt for Douglas County.

2 BASELINE OR INITIAL ANALYSIS

- Identify priority datasets to include in analysis
- Create descriptive statistics tables and visualizations for the datasets that are chosen

3 FINAL ANALYSIS

Think about what the final analysis will entail in terms of code, visualizations, statistical models, and communication.

Analyze current Douglas County youth data determining:

- Which three factors most contribute to youth trauma in the community? i.e. most prevalent?
- Quantify the financial benefit to addressing this issue to better appeal to policy makers
- Identify two pieces of effective policy and analyze their effectiveness
- Identify the numbers of youth affected by trauma in Douglas County segmented by age ranges

4 FINAL GOALS & EVALUATION

- Report outlining best policy practices for local government to address youth trauma in the community
 - o Due March 14th
- Analytical report
 - o Includes factors that contribute to youth trauma
 - o Financial impact of addressing youth trauma
 - o March 28th

5 RELATED WORK

Please cite research papers, reports, blog posts, projects, and other works you have consulted or plan to consult later. Please provide a sentence or two description that conveys the sources relevance to your project. You should have at least 5 sources.

- Youth Trauma Research: <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC2857777/>
 - Maltreatment, exposure to violence, car accidents, natural disasters, media/entertainment violence, sexual/physical abuse, separation and loss events
 - <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC3983688/#:~:text=Depending%20on%20how%20various%20traumatic,between%20caregivers%3B%201%20in%205>

6 DATA & TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

Provide expected technical requirements and relevant datasets so the course staff can best support your project needs. What software libraries do you plan to use? What datasets are you using or need access to? Anything else we (the course staff) should know?

Data sources:

- Potential contributing factors: [How was this list generated in light of our more expansive brainstorm list that has not yet been reviewed?]
 - Gun violence rates
 - Depression Rates
 - Abuse (sexual, psychological, emotional)/Neglect
 - <https://stacarecenter.org/handouts-downloads>
 - Bullying
 - Exposure to natural disasters
 - Poverty/limited access to food and resources
 - Substance Use
 - Separation and loss events
 - Involvement with the legal system
- Potential Data Sources:
- [National Child Traumatic Stress Network](#)
- [Home - Kansas Communities that Care](#)
- Greenbush
- - Community Health Assessment Douglas County
 - [National Crime Victimization Survey](#) (may not have access?)
 - [National Child Abuse and Neglect Data System](#) (state level; May only be available in PDF)
 - <https://wonder.cdc.gov/>
 - <https://www.marc.org/sites/default/files/2022-06/Greater-Kansas-City-Children-and-Youth-Needs-Assessment.pdf> (Does not include Douglas County)
 - [National Child Traumatic Stress Network](#) (may not have data just information sheets)
 - [2023 CDC BRFSS Data](#)
 - [Kansas Health Matters](#)
 - <https://www.kdhe.ks.gov/1974/Suicide-Related-Data>
 - <https://www.kdhe.ks.gov/1210/Injury-Planning-Data>
 - <https://www.kdhe.ks.gov/2225/Data-Dashboard>
 - <https://ksdata.ku.edu/sdc/region.php?tab=5&area=DG&Get+Regional+Data=Get+Regional+Data>

- <https://ksdata.ku.edu/sdc/data.shtml>
- Census Reporter:
 - <https://censusreporter.org/profiles/05000US20045-douglas-county-ks/>
 - poverty
- KBI:
 - <https://www.kansas.gov/kbi/stats/docs/pdf/DVStalking%20Rape%202023.pdf>
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- KSDE:
 - https://datacentral.ksde.org/report_gen.aspx
- <https://datacentral.ksde.org/subjectIndex.aspx>
- 2022 Homelessness Needs Assessment:
 - <https://www.dgcoks.gov/sites/default/files/media/groups/health-housing-and-human-services/pdf/douglas-county-homelessness-needs-assessment-2022.pdf>

Dr. Brennan Miller is a research associate with the University of Kansas School of Social Welfare Research team and can likely help with local data and trends.

DCF Foster Care: [Foster Care/Adoption Summary Reports - Prevention and Protection Services](#)